

Fig 6.1 : Modes of Transmission of Communicable Diseases

6.2. Definition of Fever

Fever is an increase in body temperature above the normal range (97.0°F to 98.4°F). Body temperature over 100.4°F is often considered as fever which is caused by infection or any illness. Fever is also known as "pyrexia". Fever is a natural response of the body to destroy the pathogens in the blood. This natural response of the body increases the metabolic rate of the person.

Activity : 1

What is my temperature?

Check your body temperature with digital thermometer during different parts of the day. Find out whether there is any change.



DO YOU KNOW?

Normal body temperatures are affected by factors like eating, exercise, sleeping and different time of the day. Our body temperature is usually at its highest at around six in the evening and at its lowest at three in the morning.

6.3. Causes of Fever

Fevers can be induced by "**Pyrogens**". Pyrogens are classified as follows:

1. Internal (Endogenous): These are produced within the body which causes fever. Examples are antigen-antibody reactions, malignant cancer and graft rejections
2. External (Exogenous): Fevers are caused by bacteria, fungi, virus etc. which invades the body.

Activity : 2

Refresh your memory. Remember the last time you had fever. Make a list of possible reasons for the fever.

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